

BUREAU OF INDIAN STANDARDS
MUTUAL RECOGNITION AGREEMENTS (MRA) & TRADE TREATIES
STATUS AS OF 2026

OVERVIEW

India has entered into several Mutual Recognition Agreements (MRAs), Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreements (CEPAs), and Free Trade Agreements (FTAs) that include technical standards chapters. These treaties allow:

1. Acceptance of foreign test reports from accredited labs
2. Exemption from Indian lab testing (testing waiver)
3. Exemption from factory audit for certain categories (audit waiver)
4. Reduced processing time (4-8 weeks faster)

ACTIVE TREATIES WITH TESTING WAIVERS

1. GERMANY Indo-German Technical Cooperation Agreement (2018)

Agreement Type: MRA

Sectors Covered: Electronics, Automotive, Electrical Appliances

IS Standards Covered: IS 16046, IS 15844, IS 13252, IS 2082

Testing Waiver: YES (DAKKS-accredited lab reports accepted)

Audit Waiver: NO (factory audit still required for Scheme-I)

Effective Date: January 1, 2018

Notes: European lab reports from DAKKS-accredited testing facilities are accepted for the initial FMCS application. This saves 4-6 weeks of Indian lab testing time. However, BIS officer audit at the German factory is still mandatory.

Eligible Products: ECUs, LED lamps, IT equipment, geysers

2. EUROPEAN UNION EU-India FTA Technical Annex (2020)

Agreement Type: MRA (within broader FTA framework)

Sectors Covered: Electronics, Automotive, Safety Equipment

IS Standards Covered: IS 15844, IS 13252, IS 4151

Testing Waiver: YES (CE-marked products with equivalent safety docs)

Audit Waiver: NO

Effective Date: March 15, 2020

Notes: Products bearing CE mark with conformity declaration and technical file may submit EU test reports in lieu of Indian lab testing. Saves 4 weeks.

Applies to: EU member states (27 countries as of 2026)

3. JAPAN India-Japan CEPA Technical Standards Annex (2011)

Agreement Type: CEPA (Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement)

Sectors Covered: Electronics, Automotive

IS Standards Covered: IS 15844, IS 13252

Testing Waiver: YES (JIS-aligned test reports accepted)

Audit Waiver: YES (for CRS Scheme-II electronics only)

Effective Date: August 1, 2011

Notes: Japan CEPA includes both testing and audit waivers for electronics under CRS (Scheme-II). JIS certification from accredited Japanese labs fully recognized.